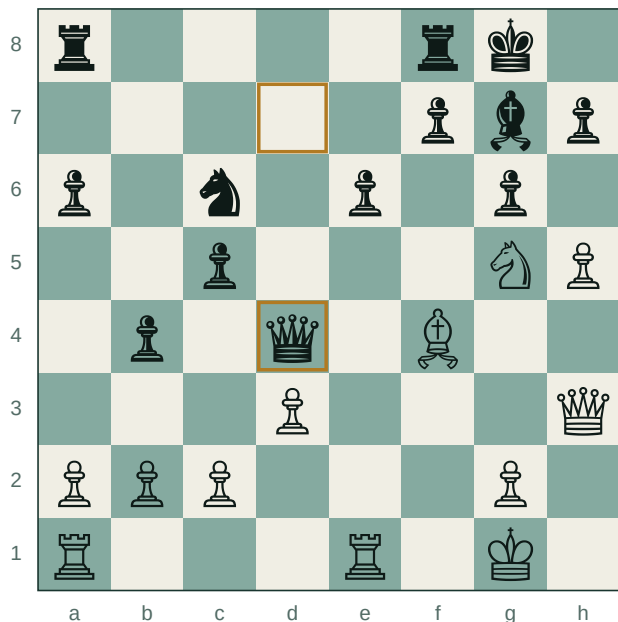


Active defensive resources: White, move 20

Active defensive resources

White to move



Previous move: 19...Qd4+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Be3 Qf6 21. Rf1 Qe5 22. hxg6 Qxe3+ 23. Qxe3

20.Be3 The bishop moves from f4 to e3. Recorded reply: **20...Qf6**.

21.Rf1 The rook moves from e1 to f1. Recorded reply: **21...Qe5**.

22.hxg6 The pawn captures the pawn on g6. Recorded reply: **22...Qxe3+**.

23.Qxe3 The queen captures the queen on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +7. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +7:** the balance goes from -1 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: knight on c6. Check for tactical protection.